

Cyber Tabletop Exercise

Pre-Release Content Theft & Public Leak Threat

Streaming Media Studio | Media & Entertainment Sector
Facilitation-ready exercise package generated from STIX 2.1 scenario data

Exercise date: To be scheduled	Duration: 90 minutes
Audience: Executive, operational, technical	Classification: Internal / Exercise Use Only

This document is fictional and intended for tabletop exercise facilitation. Do not treat any actor, infrastructure, or event as a real incident.

1. Introduction

This tabletop exercise simulates a cyber-enabled theft of unreleased streaming content shortly before a scheduled release. The scenario begins with suspicious access to pre-release episode files and escalates through public proof-of-theft, distribution partner assurance requests, and a credible threat to leak full episodes.

Source STIX scenario

The uploaded STIX bundle identifies the victim organization as **Streaming Media Studio**, a media and entertainment organization, and the incident as **Pre-Release Content Theft TTX**. The core incident description states that attackers steal unreleased media content and threaten public leaks before scheduled launch. Four STIX notes define the exercise inject progression: unusual access, proof posted, partner assurance, and public leak threat.

Assumptions made to complete the exercise

- The affected content is a flagship original series scheduled for release within five business days.
- The content repository is a cloud-based media asset management platform integrated with identity provider single sign-on and partner distribution workflows.
- No malware detonation or ransomware encryption is initially observed; the primary crisis is confidentiality, commercial impact, and public communications.
- The attacker's identity is unknown at exercise start; participants should avoid premature attribution unless evidence supports it.
- Legal, privacy, contractual, communications, content security, security operations, executive leadership, and partner management teams are in scope.

Exercise objectives

- Test escalation from a security event to a business crisis involving pre-release intellectual property theft.
- Validate roles and handoffs between SOC/incident response, content security, legal, communications, executive leadership, and partner management.
- Assess decision-making for containment, evidence preservation, partner notifications, public statements, release strategy, and law-enforcement engagement.
- Evaluate technical readiness to identify unauthorized access, validate data exfiltration, revoke access, preserve logs, and monitor for further leaks.
- Identify improvements to pre-release content protection, third-party sharing controls, and crisis communications.

Audience-specific focus

Audience	Primary exercise focus	Success indicators
Executive / crisis leadership	Business impact, release decision, legal risk, partner confidence, media response.	Clear crisis ownership, timely decisions, balanced risk appetite, consistent messaging.
Operational / business teams	Distribution workflows, partner coordination, content release options, customer/platform impacts.	Prioritized actions, accurate stakeholder mapping, documented workarounds, partner assurance plan.
Technical / SOC / IR	Access review, log preservation, scoping, containment, monitoring, forensic collection.	Defensible incident timeline, preserved evidence, revocation of risky access, detection improvements.

2. Exercise Structure and Rules of Engagement

- Duration: 90 minutes, including introduction, four inject rounds, and final debrief.
- Each inject provides limited information. Participants should act using current procedures, roles, and available facts.
- There are no right or wrong answers; the goal is to identify decision paths, assumptions, gaps, and improvement opportunities.
- Real incidents take priority. Participants may pause participation if operational duties require it.
- Do not fight the scenario. Treat the events as fictional but plausible.
- The exercise is discussion-based. No production systems will be accessed, changed, or tested.

Suggested participant roles

- Facilitator, scribe/observer, executive sponsor, CISO/security lead, incident commander, SOC/IR lead, legal counsel, privacy lead, communications lead, content security lead, distribution/partner lead, platform operations lead, customer support/PR representative.

Facilitator guidance

- Keep participants focused on decisions, not technical perfection.
- Capture open questions, owners, and evidence required for each decision.
- Separate SOC responsibilities from crisis-cell responsibilities: SOC leads technical containment and evidence; the crisis cell owns business decisions, stakeholder messaging, and risk acceptance.
- Ask participants to state who has authority to approve partner notifications, public statements, release changes, and law-enforcement contact.

3. Scenario Overview

Streaming Media Studio is preparing to launch a high-profile original series. Unreleased episodes, promotional stills, subtitles, screeners, and partner delivery packages are stored in a controlled media asset management environment. Access is granted to internal production staff, post-production vendors, distribution partners, and marketing teams based on role and release window.

On the morning of the exercise, monitoring identifies access to unreleased episode files from an unusual foreign IP address. The event appears to involve valid credentials and access paths normally used by authorized users. The incident quickly expands from a security investigation into a content protection, commercial, legal, partner assurance, and public communications crisis.

4. Inject Timeline and Facilitation Notes

Inject 1 – Unreleased Content Access

Timing: Day 1, 09:15

STIX-derived trigger: Unreleased episode files are accessed from an unusual foreign IP address.

What participants know	Expected actions
• Cloud content repository logs show access to two unreleased master files and several promotional stills. • The access used a valid account belonging to a post-production coordinator. • The user states they were not online at the time and did not approve any external login prompt. • No public leak has been observed yet.	• Declare as security incident, investigate account compromise, revoke active sessions, preserve access logs, check MFA/IdP logs, identify all accessed assets. • Notify content security, legal, privacy, platform operations, and the business owner for the series. • Decide whether to temporarily suspend external sharing or partner access while scoping the event.

Discussion questions

- Who owns the incident at this stage: SOC, content security, or crisis management?
- What evidence is needed before confirming theft versus suspicious access?
- Which controls can be safely applied without disrupting scheduled launch operations?
- Who must be informed immediately, and who should wait until facts are confirmed?

Facilitator note: Emphasize evidence preservation and controlled escalation. Challenge participants if they jump straight to public messaging before scoping facts.

Inject 2 – Leak Proof Posted

Timing: Day 1, 12:30

STIX-derived trigger: The actor posts screenshots from unreleased content as proof of theft.

What participants know	Expected actions
• Screenshots appear on a social platform and a private fan forum. • The images match scenes from unreleased episodes and include visible watermark fragments. • The actor claims to have full episodes and asks for direct contact within four hours. • Journalists begin asking whether the studio has lost control of its launch content.	• Confirm authenticity, extract forensic value from watermark fragments, engage takedown channels, update incident severity, convene crisis cell. • Prepare internal holding statement and external media lines; avoid speculation on full episode theft until validated. • Assess contractual notification obligations to talent, production partners, platforms, insurers, and distributors.

Discussion questions

- What triggers activation of the crisis cell?
- Do we contact the actor, and if so who is authorized?
- What is the public position if journalists ask before full facts are known?
- How do we preserve evidence while pursuing takedown?

Facilitator note: Probe the difference between a security severity rating and a business crisis severity rating. Look for clear authority over communications and negotiation decisions.

Inject 3 – Partner Assurance Request

Timing: Day 2, 09:00

STIX-derived trigger: Distribution partners request assurance that shared pre-release materials and release schedules remain protected.

What participants know	Expected actions
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- Two major distribution partners ask whether their copies or portals were involved.
- A partner requests written assurance before continuing promotional coordination.
- Marketing teams ask whether trailers, press kits, and embargoed reviews should proceed.
- Technical review shows several partner accounts had broad access to folders not needed for their current release window.

- Provide partner-specific facts without over-disclosing unconfirmed forensic findings.
- Review and tighten partner access, rotate shared credentials if any exist, and validate watermark lineage.
- Create an assurance package: known facts, containment actions, partner impact status, next update time, and approved points of contact.
- Decide whether the release schedule remains unchanged, is accelerated, or is delayed.

Discussion questions

- What do partners need to know, and what would create unnecessary legal or reputational risk?
- Who approves written assurances to partners?
- What changes to access controls can be implemented immediately?
- How should release strategy be reassessed if leak probability increases?

Facilitator note: Encourage participants to balance transparency with legal privilege and contractual boundaries. Watch for overpromising to partners before technical scoping is complete.

Inject 4 – Public Leak Threat

Timing: Day 2, 15:30

STIX-derived trigger: The communications team prepares a response after the actor threatens to leak full episodes publicly.

What participants know	Expected actions
• The actor posts a deadline and threatens to release full episodes within 24 hours. • A journalist sends screenshots of the threat to corporate communications. • Social chatter begins trending around the unreleased series title. • SOC confirms at least one full episode file was downloaded; investigation continues on whether additional episodes were exfiltrated.	• Move to confirmed data/content theft posture and finalize executive decision options: no engagement, controlled engagement via counsel/law enforcement, accelerated release, or delayed release with public explanation. • Finalize external holding statement, employee guidance, partner notification, and social monitoring plan. • Preserve forensic chain of custody, continue leak monitoring, and coordinate takedown requests. • Begin after-action tracking for access governance, watermarking, partner controls, and pre-release crisis playbooks.

Discussion questions

- Who makes the final decision on release strategy and actor engagement?
- What are the legal, commercial, and safety implications of each option?
- What facts can be communicated publicly now?
- What must be included in the post-incident report and lessons-learned package?

Facilitator note: Do not let the discussion become only PR-focused. Keep technical scoping, business decision-making, and legal considerations connected.

5. Decision Points

Decision point	Primary owner	Inputs required	Good exercise outcome
Incident classification and escalation	Incident commander / CISO	Access logs, asset criticality, evidence of theft, business impact	Severity reflects both technical and commercial risk.
Access containment	SOC / platform owner	Affected accounts, active sessions, partner access map	Containment protects content without unnecessary business disruption.
Partner notification	Legal / partner lead / executive sponsor	Contractual terms, confirmed impact, assurance wording	Partners receive accurate, timely, approved messages.
Public communications	Communications / legal / executive sponsor	Confirmed facts, media inquiries, social monitoring	Consistent holding statement avoids speculation and preserves trust.
Release strategy	Executive leadership / content business owner	Leak probability, revenue impact, partner readiness, marketing implications	Decision options are explicit, documented, and risk-informed.
Actor engagement	Legal / executive sponsor / law enforcement liaison	Threat credibility, evidence, policy, legal advice	No unauthorized negotiation; safe escalation path is known.
Post-incident remediation	CISO / content security / platform owner	Root cause, access review, detection gaps, partner control gaps	Remediation plan has owners, due dates, and measurable controls.

6. Technical and Business Impact Areas

Technical impacts

- Possible account compromise through valid credentials, MFA fatigue, token theft, or partner credential misuse.
- Unauthorized download of unreleased media assets from a content repository.
- Need to preserve identity provider, cloud storage, media platform, CDN, watermarking, endpoint, and partner portal logs.
- Immediate access governance review for partner accounts, dormant accounts, shared accounts, and excessive permissions.

Business impacts

- Revenue and subscriber acquisition risk if full episodes leak before launch.
- Contractual exposure involving distributors, talent, production partners, advertisers, and press embargoes.
- Reputational damage and loss of partner trust if assurance communications are slow or inconsistent.
- Potential need to change release timing, marketing plan, or content watermarking strategy.

7. Debrief and Lessons Learned

Use the final 15 minutes to capture decisions, gaps, and improvement actions. The scribe should record owners and due dates for any action items.

- What went well in the initial triage and escalation?
- Where did teams lack authority, information, or clear ownership?
- Were communications internally consistent across SOC, legal, executives, partners, and PR?
- Could the organization identify exactly what content was accessed and by whom?
- Were partner access rights appropriate for the release window?
- What detection, watermarking, logging, or data loss prevention improvements are needed?
- What playbooks should be updated before the next major content launch?

Observation area	Confidence rating 1–5	Evidence / notes	Action owner
Incident escalation			

Content access scoping			
Partner communications			
Public communications			
Release decision-making			
Forensics and evidence preservation			
Remediation tracking			

8. MITRE ATT&CK; Mapping

The mapping below reflects the scenario behaviors represented in the STIX notes and the expanded exercise. It is intended for exercise planning and detection discussion, not formal incident attribution.

Tactic	Technique	Scenario reflection	Discussion prompts
Initial Access / Defense Evasion / Persistence / Privilege Escalation	T1078 – Valid Accounts	Use of apparently legitimate access to reach unreleased content.	How are anomalous logins, MFA prompts, session reuse, and partner accounts detected?
Discovery	T1087 – Account Discovery	Potential discovery of accounts or roles that can access release folders and partner portals.	Can teams identify account enumeration and excessive access before data is downloaded?
Collection	T1213 – Data from Information Repositories	Unreleased content is stored in a media asset/content repository and accessed by the actor.	Do logs show exactly which files, folders, metadata, and previews were accessed?
Collection	T1119 – Automated Collection	Potential scripted or bulk collection of episode files and promotional assets.	Are bulk download patterns, API use, or unusual folder traversals alerted?
Exfiltration	T1041 – Exfiltration Over C2 Channel	Possible transfer of stolen content to attacker-controlled infrastructure.	What telemetry confirms whether files left the environment?
Exfiltration	T1567 – Exfiltration Over Web Service	Stolen media may be staged or transferred through legitimate web services or sharing platforms.	Can outbound transfers to cloud services be distinguished from normal production traffic?
Impact	T1491 – Defacement / public exposure analog	Public proof-of-theft and leak threat create reputational and commercial impact even without encryption.	What external monitoring and takedown procedures exist?

MITRE references used for validation: T1078 Valid Accounts, T1087 Account Discovery, T1213 Data from Information Repositories, and T1567 Exfiltration Over Web Service from the official MITRE ATT&CK; knowledge base.

9. Appendices

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Crisis cell	Cross-functional business decision group activated for significant incidents.
SOC	Security Operations Center responsible for detection, triage, containment support, and technical coordination.
IR	Incident Response team responsible for investigation, evidence preservation, and remediation support.
MAM	Media Asset Management platform used to store, process, and distribute media content.
Watermarking	Content marking used to trace copies or screenshots to users, partners, or workflows.
Takedown	Process to request removal of leaked or infringing content from platforms, forums, or hosting services.

Recommended exercise artifacts

- Artifact A: screenshot of anomalous login and file access log.
- Artifact B: mock social post showing cropped screenshot proof-of-theft.
- Artifact C: partner email requesting assurance.
- Artifact D: draft holding statement and media inquiry log.
- Artifact E: incident timeline worksheet.